# Where You Are: Step Two, Understanding Dad's Changing Care Needs

The nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, with yours marked, and what comes after it.

Planning ahead has no deadline, which makes it hard to know where to begin or how much is enough. It does have an order, though, and this is an early part of it.

Below are all nine steps with yours marked, what yours produces, and who comes into it next.

## Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Care Starting Profile

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Baseline and Preferences Profile

**You are here.** This step is about understanding how Dad manages today, while he's managing well. Your part of it, his everyday abilities, is the first of three topics. You finish it with a dated record of what he does on his own, the help already in place, the changes the family has noticed and your open questions, ready for a professional to review.

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Future Action Roadmap

## Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Preliminary Care Options Research and Decision Plan

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Planning File and Future Review Templates

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition-Readiness File and Future Handoff Template

## Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team, Communication, and Meeting-Readiness Kit

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Monitoring, Advocacy, and Review-Readiness Kit

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support

You finish with: Starter Family Care Playbook and Future Support Plan

## What this step produces

A written baseline of Dad's everyday abilities: his own account, what the family has observed, the care information his clinicians have already given him, and the questions still open, each with where it came from and a date. It is the family's record. It isn't an assessment, and it doesn't forecast anything.

Dad's account comes first in it. AARP's planning guide says a family caregiving plan must center on the wishes of the person receiving the care. [1]

Your part is finished when that record exists, every clinical question has someone to take it to, and you know who to ask about looking at things again.

## What happens next

Two more topics complete this step: the safety and support around Dad, and his own preferences about how he lives. What you write down now is where both begin. After that, the step called Define Needs takes the whole picture and sets out needs and priorities.

The record is written to be reviewed by a professional. The Family Caregiver Alliance describes professional care managers, a general name for this kind of work, as trained to assess a family's individual situation, and as working with the family, the physician and the person receiving care. [2]

## Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: noticing, asking, and writing things down with dates.
- Dad: his own account of what he does and where a hand is welcome.
- His doctor, his pharmacist and any therapist he sees: the clinical questions, what a change means, and when he should be looked at again.
- Your care consultant: meets Dad as well as talking with the family, reviews the picture across physical, cognitive, emotional and daily-living needs, and notes the medication, nutrition and therapy questions that belong with a clinician.

**What this page doesn't promise**

How long a step takes, who will be available, or how things turn out. In Plan Ahead there is no clock, and families take the steps at their own pace.

### Ready for the next step?

You know where this step sits, what it produces and who comes next. The care interview carries the step forward: it asks about each area of Dad's daily life in turn and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

**Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›**

#### WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The line about centering a plan on the person's wishes is AARP's. The description of care managers is the Family Caregiver Alliance's, and it describes the role in general.


1. AARP, Prepare to Care: A Planning Guide for Families
2. Family Caregiver Alliance, Caregiving at Home: A Guide to Community Resources